

# Niche Ecommerce Opportunity Report

Finding the next golfweights.co.uk · Three research rounds, ~45 product angles, 25+ live SERP checks · August 2026

## The 30-second version

We looked for products that work like golf club weights: tiny high-intent search market, deep brand-and-model catalogue, weak competition, cheap to ship, sold to people with money. We tested ~45 angles against real Ahrefs data and **live** Google UK results. Almost everything plausible is already taken — often by 5–10 specialists in absurdly small niches. That scarcity is the headline finding, and it's why the three survivors below deserve attention.

| # | Opportunity                                                                                                                     | Why it survived                                                                                                                                       | Realistic size (see deep dives)                                                           |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Printed &amp; branded sports matting (jigsaw mats with club logos, judo/MMA mats, boxing ring canvases, platform inlays)</b> | Google literally serves the <b>WRONG</b> product (entrance doormats) — no specialist exists. £2k–15k tickets, quote-led, supplier does the making.    | £10k–50k/mo revenue at 2–6 jobs/mo; UK commercial gym/club matting spend est. £25–50m/yr  |
| 2 | <b>Hot tub &amp; spa filters (by brand / model / filter code)</b>                                                               | 1,500+/mo measured searches, KD≈0, no dedicated specialist — just hot-tub dealers' afterthought pages. A true consumable (2–6 filters/yr per owner).  | £1.5k–3.5k/mo year 1, £3k–8k/mo year 2 with repeat base; UK filter market est. £10–40m/yr |
| 3 | <b>Caravan &amp; motorhome locker keys, catches &amp; hinges (by model / key code)</b>                                          | Perfect golf-weights shape (key-code long-tail, distress purchase, letter-post) — but <b>NOT</b> yet validated. Cheap to check before anyone commits. | ~1.3m UK caravans/motorhomes/statics; size after a 2-day validation pass                  |

### If you only remember one thing

Empty niches are nearly extinct. The one repeatable edge we found is the **mis-served SERP**: a search where Google substitutes the wrong product because the right shop doesn't exist. 'Gym mats with logo' → doormat printers. That's exactly what 'golf club weights' looked like before golfweights.co.uk. We now have a scan method for finding more of these (final section).

Everything else we tested — including several very pretty demand curves (garage door spares: ~7,000 searches/mo; greenhouse spares; made-to-measure netting: 15,000+/mo) — failed the live competition check and is documented in the Graveyard section so nobody re-treads it.

## What 'working' actually looks like

Before sizing anything, we benchmarked the two businesses we know work. The numbers are humbling in a useful way:

| Site                  | GB keywords | ...in top 3 | Organic visits/mo | Ahrefs traffic value | Reported reality                              |
|-----------------------|-------------|-------------|-------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| lifebuoysdirect.co.uk | 99          | 52          | ~1,786            | ~\$1,960/mo          | Tens of £k/month revenue (anecdotal, via Joe) |
| golfweights.co.uk     | 104         | 17          | ~399              | ~\$63/mo             | A viable, healthy niche business              |

Three lessons fall out of this table:

- 1. The bar is tiny.** A business turning over tens of thousands a month ranks for 99 keywords. You do not need big traffic — you need to own a small set of high-intent searches completely (52 of lifebuoys' 99 keywords are top-3).
- 2. Revenue per visit is enormous when intent is pure.** If lifebuoys does £20–30k/mo on ~1,800 visits, that's **£11–17 per visit**. Ordinary ecommerce sees £1–3. This is why 200-searches-a-month niches can be real businesses — and why our sizing uses revenue-per-visit ranges rather than traffic fantasies.
- 3. The face-value keyword is the tip.** golfweights ranks for 104 terms from maybe a dozen head terms — the catalogue (brand × model × spec) generates the rest. Every deep dive below therefore shows both the face-value terms *and* the long tail.

## The scarcity finding

Across three rounds we ran 25+ **live** Google UK checks (not cached SEO-tool data, which flattered several niches). Result: **only 2 of 25+ checked SERPs were genuinely open or mis-served.**

Micro-niches you would swear are empty turn out to be crowded: horse arena mirrors — 150 searches a month — has SIX dedicated specialist sites. Garage door spares has TEN. The window where you could pick any boring product and be first is largely closed; what remains is (a) mis-served intents, (b) product categories too new to have specialists, and (c) execution plays where incumbents are beatable but real.

### So what?

Treat the three survivors seriously precisely *because* the search was exhaustive. And treat the Graveyard as an asset: it's a map of what NOT to spend a year on, with evidence attached.

## The full scoreboard — 45 angles, one line each

Verdicts: **PURSUE** · **VALIDATE** / **WATCH** · **OCCUPIED** / **KILLED**. 'Live' = checked against live Google UK, not just Ahrefs cache.

| Angle                               | GB demand (denoised) | Verdict         | One-liner                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Printed/branded sports matting      | ~1,300/mo funnel     | <b>PURSUE</b>   | Mis-served SERP (doormats substitute). £2k–15k tickets. See Deep dive 2.              |
| Hot tub filters by model/code       | ~1,500/mo + tail     | <b>PURSUE</b>   | No specialist; consumable; KD=0. See Deep dive 1.                                     |
| Caravan locker keys/catches by code | not yet pulled       | <b>VALIDATE</b> | Perfect shape on paper; 2-day check before trusting. See Deep dive 3.                 |
| Headphone ear pads/cables by model  | ~160/mo + big tail   | <b>SIDE-BET</b> | Best pure matrix clone; competitive but beatable on execution. See Deep dive 4.       |
| Robot mower blades                  | ~90/mo (growing)     | <b>WATCH</b>    | Installed base compounds yearly; revisit each spring.                                 |
| Padel/pickleball consumables layer  | nascent              | <b>WATCH</b>    | Courts & canopies colonised (8 specialists); accessories not yet — demand still tiny. |
| E-scooter/e-bike mechanical spares  | unvalidated          | <b>VALIDATE</b> | Consumable + model matrix; needs its own live pass.                                   |
| Drone propellers by model           | ~280/mo              | <b>SIDE-BET</b> | KD0 model terms but DJI-direct and Amazon cap the ceiling.                            |
| Ifor Williams trailer parts         | 700/mo KD0           | <b>POSSIBLE</b> | Weak dealer SERP, but freight economics demand a dealer-partner model.                |
| Golf trolley spares & batteries     | ~460/mo              | <b>POSSIBLE</b> | Ropey specialist at pos 7 is displaceable; battery logistics drag.                    |
| Trampoline spares by brand/size     | unvalidated          | <b>VALIDATE</b> | Weather-driven repeat purchase; bulky; check in spring.                               |

### Occupied or killed (full evidence in the Graveyard section):

| Angle                                            | GB demand (denoised) | Verdict                | One-liner                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Garage door spares (Henderson/Garador/Cardale)   | ~7,000/mo            | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | Gorgeous demand; TEN spares-branded specialists on page 1.                      |
| Greenhouse spares by maker/model                 | ~3,000/mo            | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | greenhousespares.co.uk at #1 + OEM parts shops + retailers.                     |
| Made-to-measure netting (all uses)               | 15,000+/mo           | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | Huck, Henry Cowsls, nets4you, Net World Sports own both levels.                 |
| V-belts / taper-lock by code (Calda Morley play) | ~2,500/mo            | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | 6+ formalised distributors. The bearings category is done.                      |
| Cricket ground equipment (covers, screens)       | ~2,000/mo real       | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | 5+ ground-equipment firms; \$4.50 CPCs prove the value, for them.               |
| Blind spare parts                                | ~700/mo              | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | Three 'blind spares/parts'-named sites on page 1 (Joe's own check).             |
| Derailleur hangers                               | 1,500/mo GB          | <b>OCCUPIED</b>        | rearmechhanger.com IS the golf-weights of this niche already.                   |
| Stove glass / rope / bricks                      | ~950/mo              | <b>OCCUPIED</b>        | Five cut-to-size specialists.                                                   |
| uPVC door & window hardware                      | 40,000+/mo           | <b>OCCUPIED</b>        | Screwfix/Toolstation/ironmongery giants; buyer habit is set.                    |
| Toilet seat hinges by model                      | ~2,500/mo            | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | Specialist + Toolstation/Wickes/Amazon; softest of the occupied set but no gap. |
| Sofa/furniture legs                              | ~5,100/mo            | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | Two specialists + IKEA + Amazon.                                                |

| Angle                                                                                                                                                    | GB demand (denoised) | Verdict                | One-liner                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Garden furniture cushions (MTM)                                                                                                                          | ~2,500/mo            | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | Foam converters already sell custom direct (foam4u, Direct Foam...).                |
| Hot tub covers (MTM)                                                                                                                                     | ~1,300/mo            | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | Dealers + coversfortubs + The Cover Guy all offer custom-made.                      |
| Horse arena mirrors & equipment                                                                                                                          | 150/mo               | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | SIX specialists. For 150 searches. Case closed.                                     |
| Changing room benches                                                                                                                                    | 600/mo KDO           | <b>OCCUPIED (live)</b> | Workplace-catalogue giants (AJ, Slingsby, BiGDUG).                                  |
| Pizza oven accessories (Ooni/Gozney)                                                                                                                     | ~10,000/mo           | <b>OCCUPIED</b>        | Brand-direct + Amazon; tables are furniture freight.                                |
| Static caravan spares                                                                                                                                    | ~800/mo              | <b>KILLED</b>          | Demand too thin and fragmented; head terms already contested (KD 38).               |
| Commercial gym equipment spares                                                                                                                          | ~270/mo real         | <b>KILLED</b>          | The 'demand' was people buying machines, not parts.                                 |
| Watch straps / coffee-machine parts / chainsaw chains / guitar parts / appliance & mower spares / fishing spools / airgun / kayak / sash & heritage iron | various              | <b>OCCUPIED</b>        | Formalised specialists, Amazon ownership, or no Google demand — detail in workbook. |

## Deep dive 1: Hot tub & spa filters

**The certainty play.** Every hot tub eats filters — 2–6 a year, forever — and nobody in the UK has built the filter-finder site. The SERP is hot-tub dealers listing filters as an afterthought.

### Face-value demand (Ahrefs GB, 12-mo averages)

| Term                  | Vol/mo           | KD | CPC    | Note                                                                     |
|-----------------------|------------------|----|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| hot tub filters       | 1,100            | 0  | \$0.35 | Head term. US equivalent: 1,300/mo @ \$0.60                              |
| lay z spa filters     | 350              | 0  | \$0.25 | Biggest inflatable brand's own term                                      |
| intex hot tub filters | 30               | 0  | \$0.25 | Second inflatable brand                                                  |
| Model/code long-tail  | est. 2,000–4,000 | ≈0 | —      | 'pww50', 'c-4326', 'mspa filters', per-model codes — the catalogue layer |

### The long tail

Filters are indexed by industry codes (Pleatco/Unicel/Darllly cross-references) and by tub brand × model. That's a 300–800-page catalogue where every page answers one exact search — identical structure to golf weights' putter-model pages. US data confirms the tail: the #1 US page's traffic potential is 1,400 visits/mo, several times its head term.

### Competition (live Google UK unless noted)

| Who                                                          | What they are                              | Weakness                                                                                |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Happy Hot Tubs, Outdoor Living, Wave Spas, Castle, HotSpring | Hot tub dealers with filter category pages | Filters are a sideline; no code cross-reference tools; no model-finder UX; thin content |
| Amazon / eBay                                                | Listings for branded codes                 | No fitment guidance — high wrong-purchase anxiety, which a specialist converts on       |
| Bestway/Lay-Z-Spa direct                                     | OEM consumables for their own tubs         | Single-brand only; frequently out of stock in season                                    |

### Market sizing — assumptions shown, challenge them

| Layer                         | Estimate              | Basis                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| UK installed base             | ~400–700k active tubs | BISHTA industry estimates ~200k rigid tubs + inflatable boom (Lay-Z-Spa claims >1m UK units sold cumulatively; assume 30–50% active) — treat as an estimate band |
| UK filter spend               | £10–40m/yr retail     | Base × £20–60/yr filter spend per active tub                                                                                                                     |
| Search-led slice at dominance | 1,200–2,000 visits/mo | 3,500–5,500 addressable searches/mo (measured core 1,480 + est. tail) × 30–40% capture at top-3 dominance                                                        |
| Year-1 revenue                | £1.5k–3.5k/mo         | Visits × 3–5% conversion × £35 AOV (multipacks)                                                                                                                  |
| Year-2+ revenue               | £3k–8k/mo             | Repeat purchases: a 1,000-customer base re-ordering 2–4×/yr compounds independently of Google                                                                    |

All sizing uses ranges; the installed-base figures are industry estimates, not audited. Seasonality is real (peaks May–Aug) and hidden by 12-month averages.

#### Risks & what would make us walk away

Bestway locking its ecosystem (proprietary filter shapes) · Amazon price war on the top 10 codes · our conversion assumption failing because buyers default to Amazon habit. Walk away if: a re-run live SERP check shows a dedicated filter specialist has launched, or supplier quotes push landed cost above ~40% of Amazon retail.

#### Next step

One week: confirm live SERP still specialist-free → get quotes from 2 Chinese filter converters + 1 UK pool-trade wholesaler → build the code cross-reference dataset (it's public in Pleatco/Darllly charts) → soft-launch 50 SKUs on a fitment-finder site.

## Deep dive 2: Printed & branded sports matting

**The ceiling play — and Joe's own tip, which survived every test we threw at it.** Gyms, dojos, boxing clubs, schools and brands pay £2k–£15k for matting with their identity printed on it. No UK specialist exists. Google, asked for 'gym mats with logo', serves companies that print *doormats*.

### Face-value demand (Ahrefs GB, 12-mo averages)

| Term                                         | Vol/mo        | KD | CPC         | Note                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------|----|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| commercial gym flooring                      | 500           | 0  | \$1.40      | The funnel head term — buyers of fit-outs start here                    |
| custom / branded / personalised yoga mats    | ~460 combined | 0  | \$0.35–0.80 | Print-on-mat demand that already exists                                 |
| weightlifting platform                       | 250           | 0  | \$0.60      | Logo-inlay adjacent                                                     |
| boxing ring canvas                           | 150           | 0  | \$0.25      | Printable canvas; every fight night wants sponsors on it                |
| custom wrestling mats / branded gym flooring | 0             | —  | —           | Zero volume — nobody searches for what nobody sells. This is the point. |

### The long tail

This is a **demand-shaping** market, not a demand-harvesting one: the direct terms are empty because the product category has no UK shopfront. The play is to rank for the generic funnel (commercial gym flooring etc.), seed the category terms with content and PR, and convert to quotes. Caveat flagged honestly: Ahrefs' 'custom/bespoke gym flooring' long-tail contains AI-synthetic noise (e.g. 'custom brass gym flooring') — we stripped it before sizing.

### Competition (live Google UK unless noted)

| Who                                       | What they are                     | Weakness                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| First Mats, UK Mats Direct, Slip-Not      | Entrance/doormat logo printers    | Wrong product — they don't do sports matting at all. Their page-1 presence proves Google has nothing better |
| Gym Revolution, Mirafit, gym-flooring.com | Generic gym flooring retailers    | No branding/print capability, no quote-led custom offer                                                     |
| epicmats.co.uk                            | Jigsaw mats incl. a logo category | Nearest thing; thin content, no evidence of dominating the intent                                           |
| Enhance Mats (US)                         | US facility-branding specialist   | Proves the model exists commercially — and isn't here                                                       |

### Market sizing — assumptions shown, challenge them

| Layer                                | Estimate                                                                                     | Basis                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| UK facility universe                 | ~7,500 gyms + ~5,000 martial-arts/boxing/CrossFit clubs + schools, MOD, police, universities | ukactive/LDC gym counts (2024) + club directories — estimate band                                |
| UK commercial matting/flooring spend | £25–50m/yr                                                                                   | Facilities × refit cycle (5–10 yrs) × £3–25k per fit-out; branded slice nascent because unserved |
| Quote-led revenue at modest win-rate | £10k–50k/mo                                                                                  | 2–6 jobs/mo × £3–12k average job; 30–45% gross margin on supply+print                            |
| Search cost benchmark                | \$1.40–3.00 CPC                                                                              | What fit-out buyers' clicks already trade for — evidence of transaction value                    |

No installed-base consumable here; revenue is project-based with repeat via expansion/rebrand and club merch re-orders. Sales cycle weeks-not-clicks.

### Risks & what would make us walk away

It's quote-led B2B — needs sales follow-through, not just rankings · print/supply partner quality is the product · a US player (Enhance) or a big flooring firm could wake up. Walk away if: 3 supplier conversations can't produce a reliable print-on-mat route at <50% of retail, or if test outreach to 20 gyms/clubs yields zero quote interest.

**Next step**

Two weeks: map UK mat importers + dye-sub/large-format printers who'll print on EVA/vinyl/canvas (there are trade printers doing exactly this for events) → one landing page + portfolio mock-ups → rank-and-outreach test against 'commercial gym flooring' cluster. Agency skillset covers 100% of the build.

## Deep dive 3: Caravan & motorhome locker hardware (by model / key code)

**The one that still needs its homework — deliberately included so we validate before anyone falls in love.** Locker keys by code ('FW450'), catches, hinges and vents by van model. Distress purchases, letter-post, enthusiast owners.

### Face-value demand (Ahrefs GB, 12-mo averages)

| Term                     | Vol/mo | KD | CPC | Note                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------|--------|----|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (cluster not yet pulled) | —      | —  | —   | Round 1–2 prioritised other validations; this survived on pattern strength                                  |
| Audience proxies         | —      | —  | —   | 'ifor williams parts' (700/mo KD0) and caravan-adjacent pulls show the vertical searches for parts by brand |

### The long tail

Expected long-tail structure: key codes (each moulded into the lock face — owners search the code verbatim), catch/hinge model numbers (Hartal, Dometic, Thetford, W4), and van-model fitment terms. If the pattern holds it's hundreds of exact-match pages. If it doesn't show up in a matching-terms pull, the idea dies cheaply.

### Competition (live Google UK unless noted)

| Who                                          | What they are                      | Weakness                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| eBay sellers                                 | Churn listings for keys/catches    | No fitment authority, no key-code index, no next-day promise                                       |
| Leisure generalists (e.g. Leisureshopdirect) | Broad caravan accessory catalogues | Parts are buried; no code-first UX — but note: these are competent businesses. Live check required |
| OEM/dealer parts counters                    | Trade-oriented                     | Slow, phone-first, invisible to Google                                                             |

### Market sizing — assumptions shown, challenge them

| Layer            | Estimate                                                          | Basis                                                                          |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| UK audience      | ~555k touring caravans + ~400k motorhomes + ~365k holiday statics | NCC industry figures — estimate band                                           |
| Demand           | UNKNOWN — validate                                                | 2-day pass: matching-terms on key codes + brand terms, then live SERP counts   |
| Ticket/economics | £8–40 items, letter-post                                          | Key blanks & catches are commodity imports; margin structure golf-weights-like |

Do not size revenue until the keyword pull is done — that's the discipline the other 40 angles were held to.

#### Risks & what would make us walk away

Risk that Leisureshopdirect-type generalists already own every code term (the greenhouse-spares pattern) · key-cutting/security sensitivities on some codes. Walk away if: the code long-tail shows <500/mo aggregate, or any competent code-first specialist appears in the live check.

#### Next step

Two days and ~5k Ahrefs units: pull the key-code and catch-model long-tail, live-check 5 SERPs, and either promote it to the pursue list or bury it in the graveyard with evidence.



## Deep dive 4: Headphone ear pads, cables & headbands (side-bet)

The best pure golf-weights clone structurally — kept on the list as a low-capital side-bet, with its competition stated honestly (round 1 overrated it; Joe called it; we re-checked).

### Face-value demand (Ahrefs GB, 12-mo averages)

| Term                                                 | Vol/mo                            | KD | CPC          | Note                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| headphone ear pads                                   | 70                                | 1  | \$0.15       | GB face value looks tiny...                                                                                           |
| replacement ear pads                                 | 40                                | 0  | \$0.20       | ...because the demand lives at model level                                                                            |
| US structural evidence                               | —                                 | —  | —            | US #1 page's traffic potential $\approx$ 3,000 visits/mo across model terms (headphone ear pads US: 250/mo, TP 2,900) |
| Model long-tail (sony wh-1000xm4 / bose qc35 / etc.) | 10–20 each GB, hundreds of models | 0  | up to \$2.00 | Every headphone model ever made needs pads every 1–2 years                                                            |

### The long tail

One commodity product (memory-foam pads)  $\times$  every headphone model = the same catalogue math as putter weights. Pads wear out on a 12–24 month cycle, so there's a genuine repeat element. AOV is low (£12–20) which caps the ceiling — hence side-bet, not headline.

### Competition (live Google UK unless noted)

| Who                              | What they are                                    | Weakness                                                                             |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wicked Cushions (US)             | The category's global specialist, ranks #1 in GB | No UK stock/dispatch; returns friction; no UK brand warmth                           |
| Amazon / eBay / AliExpress churn | Commodity listings                               | Fitment anxiety unaddressed; quality lottery — a fit-guarantee converts against this |
| Headset Store, Lindy             | UK generalists                                   | Accessory sidelines, not model-matrix specialists                                    |

### Market sizing — assumptions shown, challenge them

| Layer                   | Estimate                              | Basis                                                                                   |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Addressable GB searches | est. 1,500–3,000/mo across model tail | Scaled from US structure (GB $\approx$ 30–40% of US volumes across this cluster)        |
| Visits at dominance     | 600–1,200/mo                          | 35–40% capture, top-3 across the tail                                                   |
| Revenue                 | £400–1,600/mo                         | 3–5% conversion $\times$ £14–18 AOV — modest, but near-zero capital and letter-post ops |

Ceiling honestly capped by AOV and Wicked Cushions' brand. Value here is also strategic: same supplier base and ops as any future matrix site.

#### Risks & what would make us walk away

Wicked Cushions launching UK fulfilment would compress the window · Amazon habit strong for commodity repurchases. Walk away if: test SKUs can't hit 40%+ margin landed, or the model-page cluster can't reach top-3 within 6 months.

#### Next step

If pursued: 30 best-selling models first (Sony/Bose/Beats/Sennheiser), fit-guarantee + UK next-day as the wedge, £2–3k stock exposure max.

## The graveyard — what we killed, with the evidence

This page exists so nobody re-treads these. Each was killed by a LIVE Google UK page-1 check (August 2026) or a decisive demand finding, not by hunch.

| Angle                                                                                  | Killer evidence (live page 1)                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Garage door spares                                                                     | TEN spares-branded sites: P C Henderson OEM, Sparesmaster, WS, UK/Online/Northwest Garage Door Spares, garagedoor-spares.com, eBay store...       |
| Greenhouse spares                                                                      | greenhousespares.co.uk ('The Specialist stockist') #1 + Halls OEM spares + Two Wests + Elloughton + Alton + Simply Garden Spares                  |
| V-belts & taper-lock (bearings/PT)                                                     | Bearing Boys, George Lodge, TransDev, Simply Bearings, Acorn, Medway PT, Bearing Station, Bearings R Us                                           |
| Horse arena mirrors                                                                    | Six specialists (made2measure, mirrors4riding, arenamirrors.com, equestrianreflections, arenamirrorsplus, simplyarenamirrors) for 150 searches/mo |
| Cricket covers & ground equipment                                                      | 3D Sports, total-play, Durant, ACS, Matchsaver, Stuart Canvas, Net World Sports                                                                   |
| Made-to-measure netting                                                                | Henry Cows, Huck Nets, nets4you, Net World custom, Cocus, safetynet365, W M James                                                                 |
| Changing room benches                                                                  | Commercial Washrooms, AJ Products, Slingsby, BiGDUG, Simply Lockers, Venesta, Continental Sports                                                  |
| Padel canopies/courts                                                                  | Eight installers (Fordingbridge, Padeltech, Portico, Rocklyn, Kit Buildings, SG Padel, Aloteks, A&S;)                                             |
| Hot tub covers (MTM)                                                                   | Happy Hot Tubs custom, coversfortubs.co.uk, The Cover Guy, Canadian Spa, dealer custom offers                                                     |
| Garden furniture cushions (MTM)                                                        | foam4u, Direct Foam, Outdoor Cushion Co., outdoor-cushion.co.uk + Amazon #1                                                                       |
| Sofa/furniture legs                                                                    | Heritage Components, Heico Direct + Amazon/IKEA/eBay/hairpin.com                                                                                  |
| Toilet seat hinges                                                                     | Choice Replacement Toilet Seat Shop, Toolstation, Croydex OEM, Plumbers-Mate, Wickes, Amazon                                                      |
| Blind spare parts                                                                      | blindspares.co.uk, blindspartsdirect.co.uk, blindparts.co.uk + Blinds By Post, Direct Order Blinds (Joe's live check concurs)                     |
| Deraileur hangers                                                                      | rearmechhanger.com holds #1 AND #2; Halfords beneath                                                                                              |
| Stove glass/rope/bricks                                                                | stoveglassreplacement.co.uk, UK Glass Centre, Fast Glass Direct, Stove Supermarket, Glowing Embers...                                             |
| Static caravan spares                                                                  | Demand ~800/mo fragmented across 50 micro-terms; head terms already KD 38–39                                                                      |
| Commercial gym equipment spares                                                        | Keyword pull showed the demand is machine PURCHASES; real spares searches ~270/mo                                                                 |
| uPVC hardware / pizza-oven accessories / mobility batteries / AGA spares / van racking | Sheds & giants (Screwfix, Amazon), brand-direct (Ooni/Gozney), battery chains, agaspares-type incumbents, Bri-Stor/Van Guard et al                |

### Data honesty note

Ahrefs volumes contained AI-synthetic keyword families that inflate niches: 'cricket pitch protection covers {city}' ×10 (~850/mo of fake demand), 'custom brass gym flooring', 'equestrian menage covers near me'. We stripped these before sizing anything. Raw keyword exports elsewhere will overstate several of these markets.

## The repeatable edge: the mis-served SERP scan

The one pattern that reliably found opportunity: **search for a product a business would buy, and watch Google substitute something else.** 'Gym mats with logo' → doormats. 'Golf club weights' (pre-golfweights) → info pages. The substitution means demand exists but supply doesn't — the only kind of 'empty' left on Google in 2026.

### How to run it as a production line:

1. **List quote-led B2B/prosumer products** currently bought via sales reps, trade counters, or 'ring us' brochure sites (the Calda Morley shape) — especially anything customised, printed, cut-to-size or model-fitted.
2. **Live-search 3–5 buyer phrasings each.** Score: specialists on page 1 (0 = candidate), and whether Google substitutes a different product (substitution = strong candidate).
3. **Only then pull keyword data** — face value AND long tail, stripping synthetic families — and size top-down from the buyer universe, bottom-up from search.
4. **Supplier before site.** Each surviving candidate is only real once a supplier/printer/fabricator quotes a landed cost leaving 40%+ margin.

## Recommended sequence from here

| When      | Action                                                                                                              | Cost                             |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Week 1    | Hot tub filters: re-confirm live SERP, get 3 supplier quotes, build the filter-code cross-reference dataset         | Days of effort, ~£0 capital      |
| Weeks 1–2 | Branded matting: supplier/printer mapping + one landing page + 20-club outreach test                                | Days of effort; test spend <£500 |
| Week 2    | Caravan hardware: the 2-day validation pass (promote or bury)                                                       | ~5k Ahrefs units                 |
| Ongoing   | Run the mis-served SERP scan monthly as an agency habit; revisit robot-mower blades & padel consumables each spring | An hour a month                  |

## Method & data appendix

**Sources:** Ahrefs API (keyword volumes, difficulty, CPC, traffic potential; GB + US; 12-month averages — seasonality hidden), SERPAPI live Google UK results (August 2026), site metrics for calibration benchmarks, live site inspections. **Spend:** ~22,000 Ahrefs API units across three rounds (~5% of monthly workspace budget).

**Companion file:** Niche-Product-Longlist.xlsx (same repo) holds the full scorecard, 160+ keyword rows, and per-check evidence. **Key caveats:** installed-base figures (hot tubs, gyms, caravans) are industry estimates, not audited; lifebuoysdirect revenue is anecdotal; revenue models are ranges with stated assumptions — challenge the assumptions, not the arithmetic. All CPCs shown in USD as reported by Ahrefs.

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